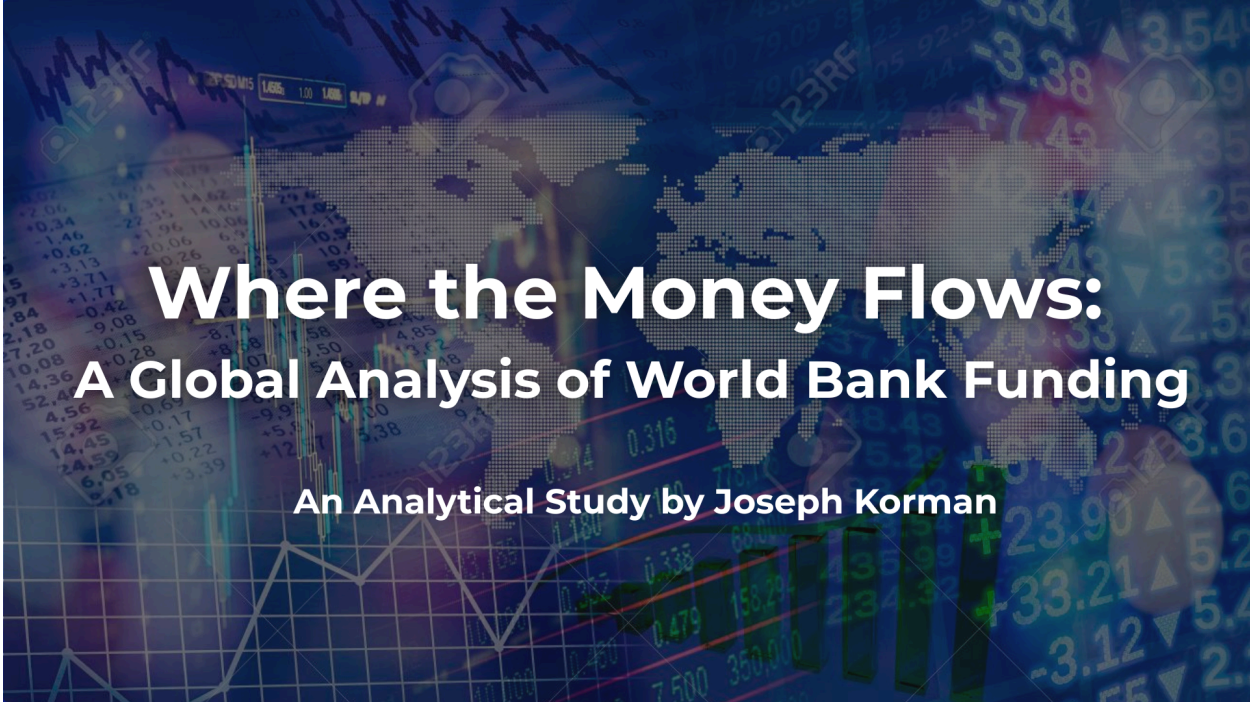




Where the Money Flows: A Global Analysis of World Bank Funding

An Analytical Study by Joseph Korman

Using SQL to analyze which countries receive the most funding and owe the most to the World Bank.

Growing up, I never imagined I'd be analyzing global bank funding data. Yet here I am, exploring which countries the World Bank invests in the most, and which ones owe the most in return. This project was a deep dive into global finance, international priorities, and surprising patterns hidden in over a million rows of data.

Why I Chose This Project

I wanted to simulate the role of a bank data analyst and practice SQL on a large, real-world dataset. The World Bank's funding decisions shape economies, influence development, and reveal a lot about global financial strategies. This project let me analyze that at scale and uncover fascinating insights that actually matter to people everywhere.

By reading this, you will learn **which countries receive the most funding, who owes the most, how regions compare**, and the **unexpected patterns** that surfaced during analysis. If you're curious about global finance, SQL analytics, or large-scale datasets, this is the analysis for you!

About this Dataset

- **Source:** [World Bank's IDA Statement of Credits, Grants, and Guarantees](#)
- **Size:** 1,488,150 rows
- **Coverage:** 145 countries and economies
- **Currency:** All values in this dataset were converted to US Dollars for convenience
- **Last Update:** October 31, 2025

The dataset included variables such as original principal amounts, repayment statuses, regions, and financial classifications. It was the perfect playground for large-scale SQL queries, aggregations, and comparisons.

Key Findings

- **India and Bangladesh** have the most *individual records*.
- **India has received the most funding overall (which is likely because India appears the most often in the dataset)**
- **Ukraine owes the most per loan on average**, despite having far fewer records than most other countries in the data.
- **Ukraine has not repaid a single loan recorded here.**
- **South Asia and Africa are the two regions that have received the most funding in total.**
- **The Biggest Key Insight:** Ukraine's outsized debt load contradicts the assumption that countries with more records (like India) would owe the most.

In this project, I aim to answer the following question: How do World Bank funding allocations and repayment behaviors vary across countries and regions, and what patterns emerge regarding financial risk and dependency?

To answer this question, I wrote various SQL queries to both clean up the data and to uncover valuable insights, such as:

1. **Which countries appear the *most often* throughout this dataset?**
2. **Which countries and regions receive the *most funding*?**

3. Which countries owe *the most* to the IDA?

- Subsequently, what is the *credit status* for each loan for the countries that owe the most?

Key Findings From This Analysis

Funding Totals by Region

```
SELECT Region,
       SUM("Original Principal Amount (US$)") AS "Region Total"
FROM banking_data
GROUP BY Region
ORDER BY "Region Total" DESC;
```

	Region	Region Total
1	SOUTH ASIA	21025819894768.24
2	AFRICA	16077982327030.246
3	EAST ASIA AND PACI...	7378625962907.499
4	EASTERN AND SOUT...	6898955499616.184
5	WESTERN AND CEN...	5293609297483.989
6	EUROPE AND CENT...	2794016708581.3794
7	AFRICA EAST	2678789229657.162
8	AFRICA WEST	2073956945566.4102
9	LATIN AMERICA AND...	1935440411832.5996
10	MIDDLE EAST AND N...	1454855373674
11	Eastern and Souther...	281803423395.9199
12	Western and Central ...	220197926244.41998
13	MID EAST,NORTH AF...	218052582740.76004
14	OTHER	55500000

South Asia and Africa emerge as the largest recipients, aligning with global development goals.

Number of Records for Each Country (and their Total Funds Received)

```
SELECT "Country / Economy", COUNT("Country / Economy") AS Records,
      SUM("Original Principal Amount (US$)") AS "Total Received"
FROM banking_data
GROUP BY "Country / Economy"
ORDER BY Records DESC, "Total Received" DESC;
```

	Country / Economy	Records	Total Received
1	India	74225	8724316380721.629
2	Bangladesh	54214	5230292389191.443
3	Pakistan	46631	4207405107433.688
4	Tanzania	44485	2617117767404.228
5	Ghana	40280	1944317801333.766
6	Ethiopia	35838	3727656368789.7686
7	Senegal	34770	1071528883752.2784
8	Yemen, Republic of	33720	914248625089.02
9	Kenya	33505	2388736660735.54
10	Uganda	32832	1760811423162.8398
11	Madagascar	31029	986997735261.52
12	Malawi	30617	885389089709.3401
13	Burkina Faso	29269	1025392322186.34
14	Nepal	29197	1118347766517
15	Mali	28238	795884335422.6401
16	Mozambique	26409	1442482600006.637

Here we can see that India and Bangladesh lead in the number of records, showing the frequency of financial interactions.

Money Due: Descriptive Statistics

```
-- Descriptive Stats
SELECT "Country / Economy", avg("Due to IDA (US$)") AS Average,
max("Due to IDA (US$)") AS Max, min("Due to IDA (US$)") AS Min
FROM banking_data
GROUP BY "Country / Economy"
ORDER BY Average DESC;
```

	Country / Economy	Average	Max	Min
1	Ukraine	760434724.2771546	4800000000	0
2	Nigeria	81398290.42260818	750000000	-0.01
3	Vietnam	73514993.28237803	418952018.2	0
4	Viet Nam	63869453.2121951	305819895.2	0
5	Lebanon	61761490.937181845	92805370.57	0
6	Iraq	53220764.19433144	108921406.7	1924542
7	India	52995292.79559862	793256127.6	-0.02
8	Pakistan	52562415.98959508	640603392	-0.02
9	Bangladesh	48180854.38865744	595116712.67	-0.01
10	Uzbekistan	42110405.51964653	500000000	0
11	Ethiopia	37469776.91510895	621352567	-0.07
12	Kenya	36087802.230972156	780555197.6	-0.01
13	Zimbabwe	32566566.20691615	144871179.5	0
14	Fiji	29460310.62001724	110372788	0
15	Tanzania	27818871.465502843	500000000	-0.09
16	Myanmar	27813165.64435459	423303090.8	0

Ukraine stands out here with extremely high outstanding balances despite far fewer transactions in the dataset overall (123 total records).

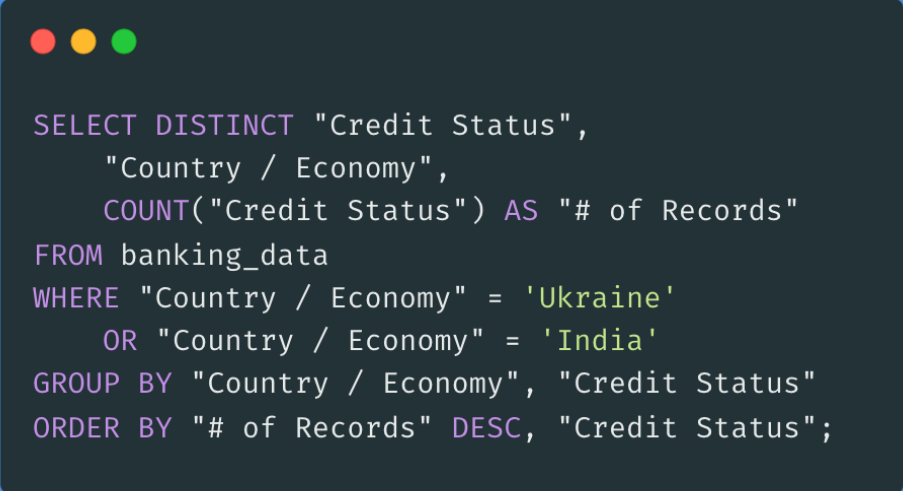
Credit Status Counts (All Countries)

```
SELECT DISTINCT "Credit Status", COUNT("Credit Status") AS "# of Records"
FROM banking_data
GROUP BY "Credit Status"
ORDER BY "# of Records" DESC;
```

	Credit Status	Country / Economy	# of Records
1	Repaying	India	48211
2	Repaying	Bangladesh	31028
3	Repaying	Pakistan	22647
4	Repaying	Yemen, Republic of	18307
5	Fully Repaid	Tanzania	17792
6	Fully Repaid	Ghana	17514
7	Repaying	Kenya	17084
8	Repaying	China	15357
9	Fully Repaid	Madagascar	14456
10	Repaying	Sri Lanka	14069
11	Fully Repaid	Senegal	13900
12	Fully Repaid	Uganda	13344
13	Fully Repaid	Malawi	12649
14	Repaying	Nepal	12252
15	Disbursed	India	11932
16	Fully Repaid	Bolivia	11537

Highlights repayment progress across the dataset. Since we have been focused on India and Ukraine’s results up until now, I decided to filter these results for just India and Ukraine below.

Credit Status Counts (India and Ukraine Only)



```
SELECT DISTINCT "Credit Status",  
               "Country / Economy",  
               COUNT("Credit Status") AS "# of Records"  
FROM banking_data  
WHERE "Country / Economy" = 'Ukraine'  
      OR "Country / Economy" = 'India'  
GROUP BY "Country / Economy", "Credit Status"  
ORDER BY "# of Records" DESC, "Credit Status";
```

	Credit Status	Country / Economy	# of Records
1	Repaying	India	48211
2	Disbursed	India	11932
3	Disbursing	India	5253
4	Fully Repaid	India	4499
5	Disbursing&Repaying	India	1627
6	Fully Disbursed	India	1203
7	Repaid	India	579
8	Effective	India	381
9	Approved	India	256
10	Fully Cancelled	India	139
11	Disbursing	Ukraine	114
12	Signed	India	109
13	Cancelled	India	36
14	Approved	Ukraine	6
15	Signed	Ukraine	3

Ukraine's Debt Details

```

SELECT "Country / Economy", "Due to IDA (US$)",
      "Repaid to IDA (US$)", "End of Period", "Credit Status"
FROM banking_data
WHERE "Country / Economy" = 'Ukraine'
ORDER BY "Due to IDA (US$)" DESC;

```


	Country / Economy	Due to IDA (US\$)	Repaid to IDA (US\$)	End of Period	Credit Status
1	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-09-30T00:00:...	Disbursing
2	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-08-31T00:00:...	Disbursing
3	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-07-31T00:00:0...	Disbursing
4	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-06-30T00:00:...	Disbursing
5	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-05-31T00:00:...	Disbursing
6	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-04-30T00:00:...	Disbursing
7	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-02-28T00:00:...	Disbursing
8	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-03-31T00:00:...	Disbursing
9	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2024-12-31T00:00:0...	Disbursing
10	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-01-31T00:00:0...	Disbursing
11	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2024-11-30T00:00:0...	Disbursing
12	Ukraine	4800000000	0	2025-10-31T00:00:0...	Disbursing
13	Ukraine	1110953616.79	0	2025-09-30T00:00:...	Disbursing
14	Ukraine	1108850076.77	0	2025-06-30T00:00:...	Disbursing
15	Ukraine	1103575950.13	0	2025-08-31T00:00:...	Disbursing
16	Ukraine	1094448452.73	0	2025-10-31T00:00:0...	Disbursing

A Breakdown of all 123 of Ukraine's records for further insight. Note that all records under "Repaid to IDA" are at 0, indicating that Ukraine has yet to pay anything back to the IDA.

Main Takeaways

- **Higher volume of records ≠ higher total debt.** Ukraine disproved this immediately by having far more debt and the largest maximum fund than anyone else.
- **South Asia and Africa are strategic regions** for development lending.
- **Repayment history should be a major factor in future funding decisions.**
- **Large datasets reveal stories you don't expect**, especially when using SQL to surface patterns.

Conclusion

This project not only strengthened my SQL skills but also expanded my understanding of the world of global finance. Analyzing over a million records required lots of critical thinking about lending, debt sustainability, political context, and how quantitative data ties into real-world outcomes. Although this process was challenging, it was also incredibly meaningful and rewarding. It solidified my passion for working with data in a way that helps organizations understand problems and act on what the numbers reveal.

Based on my findings, I believe businesses and global institutions should **evaluate repayment histories more heavily** when offering new loans. This can lead to sustainable funding strategies, stronger financial oversight, and better resource allocation.

If you're interested in discussing this project in further detail, or if you want to see other data analytics projects I have worked on, please check out my portfolio and connect with me! Additionally, if somebody you know is looking for a passionate data analyst who loves uncovering insights like these, feel free to connect us to discuss more. Thank you for reading, and I'm excited to continue sharing more data-driven projects soon!